Critique language glossary

01 / Understand the task

Precise words for describing what is working and what is not.

Use precise, useful language when discussing creative work.

Choose one small, real example to work on. A focused attempt gives you better evidence than a general impression.

Your example: _____

Your audience: _____

Your intended outcome: _____

One constraint: _____

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02 / Put a method to work

1. Hierarchy: the order in which attention is directed. Name what you noticed first.

2. Contrast: a meaningful difference in scale, weight, space or tone.

3. Rhythm: repetition and variation that shape how a composition is read.

4. Alignment: a shared edge or axis that makes relationships clearer.

5. Affordance: a clue about an available action; check whether the clue is accurate.

6. Rationale: the reason for a decision in relation to the goal and constraints.

Working notes: _____

_____

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03 / A worked practice scenario

Vague: "This feels off." Specific: "The secondary button attracts attention before the main task because it has stronger contrast."

Useful next step: "Try lowering the secondary emphasis, then ask someone which action they notice first."

Separate observation, effect and suggestion. Avoid presenting personal preference as a universal rule.

Apply the method to your own example. What changes?

Your first attempt: _____

Your revision: _____

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04 / Reflect and keep going

Could the learner turn your feedback into one concrete experiment?

What is clearer after using this workbook?

_____

What evidence supports that conclusion?

_____

What is the smallest useful next step?

_____

Feedback prompt: "I noticed ____. That helped / made it harder to ____. One thing to try is ____."

You may adapt this original sample workbook for personal learning and classroom demonstrations.

This is sample learning material, not legal, financial, medical or accreditation advice.